

The Way Thing Rolled

Diary of events of the XII Indian Scientific Expedition to Antarctica (ISETA) and the X Winter-over team (WOT).

Action Stations

- | | |
|-----------------|--|
| 06 & 07 Aug.'92 | Presentation of Scientific protocols at the India International Centre, New Delhi for the selection of the team. |
| 09-09-'92 | Snow-ice and Winter-craft training course for cold acclimatisation. |
| 24-11-'92 | MV <i>Thuleland</i> berths at the Vasco-da-gama Port, Goa. |
| 28-11-'92 | Loading operations begin. |
| 05-12-'92 | Farewell ceremony held on the dock. |

Southwards Bound

- | | |
|-----------|--|
| 05-12-'92 | Ship sets sail for Antarctica at 19.40 hrs.
First Official 'out' message from the ship to NHQ. |
| 09-12-'92 | Equator crossed at 02.30 hrs.
Total Lunar eclipse witnessed. Total phase began at 23.07 hrs and ended at 00.21 hrs (10-12-'92). |
| 12-12-'92 | Ice-breaking party at 18.00 hrs. |
| 13-12-'92 | Ship cruises past Mauritius. |
| 16-12-'92 | Scientists day celebrated. |
| 17-12-'92 | Entered the "Roaring Forties" (Past 40°S).
Sighted a Hump-backed Whale. |
| 19-12-'92 | Vegetation seen for the last time in the 16 months to come as we sailed past Prince Edwards and Marion Islands (S.A.).
The huge Albatross and the diminutive petrels sighted. |
| 20-12-'92 | First snow-fall experienced.
Encountered the "Furious Fifties" (50°S).
First ice-berg sighted (50°19'S) at 14.39 hrs. |
| 24-12-'92 | Crossed 60°S, into the "Screaming Sixties". |

- Capt. Hedlund presented mementos to all members on the eve of Christmas and hosted a lavish party.
- 27-12-'92 Last sunset seen. Continuous daylight ensues.
- 28-12-'92 Arrival at Antarctica, 21.05 hrs.
- 30-12-'92 MI-8 helicopters taken out of the hold.
- 31-12-92 Trial flight by one of the MI-8s at 19.40 hrs.
New year celebration.
- 01-01-'93 Courtsey visit to Maitri at about 1000Z. The Summer camp established the same evening.

Summer Period

- 01-01-'93 A few scientists with their gear flown to Maitri.
- 02-01-'93 Bad weather thwarts all attempts of flying.
Scientific activities get underway.
Construction of new gen-shed starts.
Logistic tasks at Maitri start in full swing.
- 09-01-'93 The first snow-fall witnessed at Maitri.
- 14-01-'93 Official visit to Novo and George Forster stations by the Leader and Station Commander.
- 18-01-'93 New INMARSAT terminal commissioned at Maitri.
- 26-01-'93 Republic Day celebrated at Maitri and on board the Ship as weather did not permit flying into Maitri.
- 01-02-'93 Maitri formally taken over by the X WOT.
First 'IN' message received at Maitri from NHQ.
- 03-02-'93 First get-together at Maitri hosted by the Navy team.
- 10-02-'93 Summer camp officially wound up. Summer team leaves Maitri.
- 15-02-'93 Combined convoy of IX and X WOT's departs for DG and India-bay at the shelf.
- 18-02-'93 New gen-shed named "Aditya" commissioned.
Ship leaves for Neumayer, the German station 600 km North-West of Maitri at 1900Z.

Winter Period

- 19-02-'93 Return convoy departs from DG.
Convoy reaches Maitri at 20.30 hrs, same day.

- 21-02-'93 Ship reaches Neumayer, picks up 4 members and a few cargo containers to be dropped at Mauritius.
- 24-02-'93 Second convoy leaves for DG at 04.00 hrs.
- 03-03-'93 Second convoy returns at 05.00 hrs.
- 07-03-'93 "Holi" celebrated with traditional gaiety. Russian guests from Novo joined the celebrations.
- 08-03-'93 Inaugural issue of "The Maitri Times", in-house station monthly magazine.
- 09-03-'93 3rd convoy departs at 05.00 hrs.
- 13-03-'93 Convoy returns at 04.00 hrs.
- 14-03-'93 A few Scientists of the new Russian team from the ship *Akademik Fedorov* visit Maitri along with our first ever female guest and the two members of Swiss Antarctic team. Leader and a few other members visit the Russian ship *Akademik Federov*.
- 17-03-'93 Priyadarshini lake freezes completely.
- 21-03-'93 The fourth convoy leaves for the shelf at 09.30 hrs.
- 22-03-'93 We receive the news of MV *Thuleland* reaching Goa safely.
- 23-03-'93 Valeri Fedorov, the leader of the new Russian team, the 38th Russian Antarctic expedition visits Maitri. IMD day celebrated. Mr S Venkateswarlu highlights role of IMD.
- 24-03-'93 The 4th convoy returns at 02.30 hrs.
- 25-03-'93 Id-ul-fitr celebrated.
- 28-03-'93 Two Russian polar-men who had lost their way back to Novo rescued.
- 06-04-'93 The two member Swiss Antarctic team consisting of Capt. Markus Ritzi and Urs Mokli visit Maitri. They stayed with us and worked on a story about the Indian Antarctic station for a Swiss magazine.
- 07-04-'93 The 5th convoy departs. Capt. Markus accompanies the Indian convoy.
- 08-04-'93 April issue of The Maitri Times released.
- 09-04-'93 Convoy returns.
- 11-04-'93 Farewell party for Mr Pugachev, Leader and his team, the 37 Russian Antarctic Expedition.
Easter celebrated.

- 13-04-'93 Maitri Matter - Lecture series begins. Talk by Nb Sub Swaran Singh on the functioning and maintenance of Boiler-room.
- 20-04-'93 6th convoy - Route marking started.
- 25-04-'93 Maitri Matter - Talk by NK AB Joshi on the role of Dozers at Maitri with a word on maintenance.
- 27-04-'93 7th convoy - Route marking continues.
- 04-05-'93 8th convoy leaves for India bay.
- 08-05-'93 The Maitri Times hits the stand - May issue.
- 12-05-'93 Convoy returns.
- 27-05-'93 Last sunrise of the summer.
Three Russian polar-men, lost during a blizzard were rescued by a party of members from Maitri.
- 01-06-'93 Talk by S. Pasha POEL(R) on the electronic equipment used for communication.
- 02-06-'93 A record was set as the 9th convoy to the shelf and back took a total of only 23 hrs and 11 min. It was for the first time that a convoy was undertaken during Polar-nights from Maitri. Marine Biological sampling was accomplished.
- 08-06-'93 Mr RP Lal talks on Weather forecasting - Maitri Matter.
- 15-06-'93 Maitri Matter - HMT Vilas Shinde talks about the vehicles used in Antarctica, with special emphasis on their maintenance.
- 17-06-'93 Indo-Russian Cross-country race was conducted as a part of the Mid-winter celebrations.
Mid-winter greetings received from the President of USA, Mr Bill Clinton.
- 18-06-'93 Shri PV Narasimha Rao, the Prime Minister of India sends greetings for Mid-winter Day.
- 21-06-'93 Mid-winter Day celebrated at Maitri.
- 22-06-'93 Novo-Lazarevskaya celebrates Mid-winter Day.
- 29-06-'93 Raman talks on Electrical systems - Maitri Matter.
- 07-07-'93 A pair of Wilson's storm Petrels sighted.
- 08-07-'93 The Maitri Times - July issue released.
- 13-07-'93 Maitri Matter - Mr Rajesh Asthana enlightens the lot with Palaeontological evidences regarding evolution of man.
- 19-07-'93 First sunrise after the Polar night.
- 27-07-'93 Maitri Matter - SP Jothi, POCK(O). Shortest talk of the series.

- 29-07-'93 10th convoy departs for DG.
- 05-08-'93 Convoy returns.
- 08-08-'93 August issue of The Maitri Times published.
- 10-08-'93 Mr KR Sivan lectures on the correct way of undertaking a Work Study - Maitri Matter.
- 15-08-'93 Independence Day celebrated. The Russian leader and a few members from Novo graced the occasion.
- 24-08-'93 Maitri Matter - An erudite talk on the functioning and maintenance of gen-sets by Nb Sub KK Bakshi.
- 30-08-'93 Out message "touch" 500 mark.
- 01-09-'93 The first Ozone sonde ascent by IMD team for ROSA '93.
- 04-09-'93 11th convoy departs.
- 12-09-'93 Convoy returns.
- 14-09-'93 SK Sharma MCPOR(Tel) talks on Naval communication - Maitri Matter.
- 19-09-'93 Vinayak Chaturthi celebrated.
- 28-09-'93 Maitri Matter - Hav Navinder Singh talks about "Wood".
- 07-10-'93 12th convoy leaves for the shelf.
- 08-10-'93 October edition of The Maitri Times delivered on the doorstep.
- 09-10-'93 Convoy returns.
- 12-10-'93 Mr Arun Chaturvedi delights all with an informative talk about Antarctica, with special emphasis on its geo-political status.
- 15-10-'93 The Golden jubilee of EME celebrated.
- 19-10-'93 Maitri Matter - Sub Ajit Singh talks about the electrical components of gen-sets.
- 24-10-'93 Dushehra celebrated.
Skua sighted for the first time after the winters.
- 28-10-'93 Two Penguins visit Maitri station.
- 02-11-'93 Maitri Matter - Nb Sub T Jambunathan explains about welding and relates the problems faced in welding under sub-zero temperatures.
- 03-11-'93 13th Convoy leaves for the shelf.
- 05-11-'93 Convoy takes only 7 hr and 30 min. to return. An all time record set.
Station was maintained successfully on one gen-set (2000Z - 0600Z) for the first time, on a trial basis, as a fuel saving measure.

- 08-11-'93 November copy of The Maitri Times sent forth.
- 09-11-'93 Maitri Matter - Talk on Naval communication and the salient features of good communication by Lt Cdr HD Sharma.
- 13-11-'93 Deepawali celebrated in grand style.
- 15-11-'93 Vishvakarma Pooja performed.
- 16-11-'93 Sapper's Corps Day celebrated.
Sign-pillar with names of home-towns of all members of the X-WOT along with distances in km from Maitri erected.
- 28-11-'93 Indian humble the Russian spikers at Volley-ball, in a match between the two neighbouring stations, played at Novo-Lazarevskaya.
- 29-11-'93 Guru Nanak Jayanti celebrated.
- 30-11-'93 HMT K Sadanandan talks of his experiences in Antarctica and about the role of EME-Maitri Matter.
- 04-12-'93 Navy Day celebrated.
- 05-12-'93 Exactly one year since we departed from Goa.
- 08-12-'93 December issue of The Maitri Times released.
MV *Stepan Krasheninnikov* sails for Antarctica with the XIII Indian Scientific Expedition at 13.30 hrs IST, from Goa.
- 16-12-'93 Scientists Day celebrated.
- 22-12-'93 Maitri Matter - Talks by Nb Sub Swaroop Singh, Lt Col DVS Rathee, Dr Vinod K Dhargalkar, Lt Col G Ravindranath and Lt Col VS Grewal.
- 23-12-'93 Dr Nalin Mehta talks about Medical Research at Maitri - The last of Maitri Matter lectures.
- 24-12-'93 Christmas eve celebrated.
- 30-12-'93 MV *Stepan Krasheninnikov* arrives in Antarctica.
- 31-12-'93 Courtesy visit by the new team. Penguin lands at Maitri at 10.54 hrs, with letters from home.
New Year's Eve - grand party.

Aloha Summer

- 01-01-'94 AMC Day celebrated.
"Out" messages cross the 1000 mark.

- 11-01-'94 The leader and members of the new Russian Antarctic team pay us a courtesy visit along with Dr Pomelov Victor, an environmentalist from the Russian Antarctic Institute.
- 21-01-'94 Swedish Inspection team visited Maitri.
- 23-01-'94 Courtesy visit to Novo-Lazarevskaya by the new Leader Mr G Sudhakar Rao and the Station Commander Dr Vinod K Dhargalkar.
- 26-01-'94 Republic Day celebrated.
- 01-02-'94 Station handed over ceremoniously to the XI Winter-over team.
- 13-02-'94 Joint convoy left Maitri at 2100 hrs.
- 14-02-'94 Joint convoy arrived shelf at 1035 hrs.
- 15-02-'94 2nd joint convoy carrying XI winter over stores left shelf at 1415 hrs and arrived Maitri at 0630 hrs on 16 Feb. Courtesy visit to MV *Mikhel Somov* by Mr G Sudhakar Rao and Dr VK Dhargalkar.
- 16-02-'94 Master, crew and Norwegians from MV *Mikhel Somov* visited MV *Stepan Krashninnikov*.
- 23-02-'94 Russian Defender of Motherland Day celebrated.
- 28-02-'94 National Science Day celebrated.
- 24-03-'94 Crossed 40°S at 1835 UTC.
- 27-03-'94 Holi celebrated.
- 29-03-'94 Arrived in port Durban (South Africa) at 0930 UTC.
- 30-03-'94 Dry docking for the inspection and repairs of rudder.
- 06-04-'94 Team members flew to India.